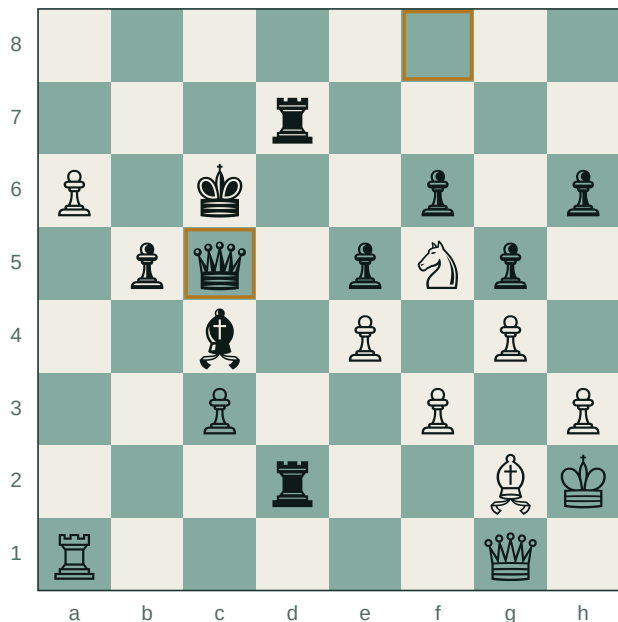


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 41

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 40...Qc5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41. Qxc5+ Kxc5 42. a7 Rxa7 43. Rxa7 Bf1 44. Ne3 Bxg2 45. Nxg2

41.Qxc5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From c5 it attacks king on c6 and bishop on c4. Recorded reply: **41...Kxc5**.

42.a7 The pawn moves from a6 to a7. Recorded reply: **42...Rxa7**.

43.Rxa7 The rook captures the rook on a7. Recorded reply: **43...Bf1**.

44.Ne3 The knight moves from f5 to e3. Recorded reply: **44...Bxg2**.

45.Nxg2 The knight captures the bishop on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on c6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.